only after studying the social impact his business policies could have on them and the local population. He also underscored the need to be socially sensitive not only within the country, but also when the group expanded into foreign nations.

Describing how he would identify the countries in which to expand the group's business, Ratan told the *McKinsey Quarterly* in 2005: 'So in the first instance we have chosen countries where we felt we could make an impact and, secondly, where we are able to participate as we have in India, in the development of that country.'

He surprised the international business community by giving expression to this priority. When asked by a journalist in 2009 about the business opportunities that a recession-hit US could offer Indian industrialists, Ratan's answer revealed his deep concern for workers everywhere. He said that it was necessary to ensure that India did not earn the opprobrium of a job stealer. It should 'not be aggressive and alien to the kind of pain' that the US was experiencing and use its cost advantage 'to the benefit of US companies without in fact taking jobs away from them', he elaborated.

Both the foreign entity and the host nation should benefit from any merger or acquisition, according to Ratan. Such an approach would achieve his twin objectives of finding new markets for his business and creating opportunities in the region for the local populace. For instance, after the new democratic government was formed in South Africa in 1994, Ratan established Tata Holdings Africa the following year. It was made responsible for 'identifying development and investment opportunities and promoting new projects'.

The core of Ratan's philosophy to assign particular importance to social development also yielded substantial business dividends. The 'principle of corporate social investment and "giving back" to the communities in which it operates' helped build 'business and loyalty in Africa'. According to a study, 'This gives Tata a considerable competitive advantage in a developing [continent] such as Africa that sets great store by partnerships that emphasize local development and nation building.'

Developing strong ties with academic circles and providing internships to students without any obligation for them to work in the company later, are policies that Tata Chemicals adopted in its Magadi plant. As Joes Sayanka, the Masai chief of Magadi, tells me, the Tatas have been actively involved in a community skill upgradation programme called Community Skill